importance for all that follows. This is the borderline between the mental processes within other individuals and the mental processes within one's own Ego. For everybody experiences his own emotions and sensations directly. They just simply exist for him. But we do not experience directly the sensations of any other individuals, however certain their existence may be, and we can only infer them in analogy to our own sensations. To be sure, there are physicians who solemnly claim to be able to perceive the emotions and moods of their patients no less clearly than the latter themselves. But such a claim can never be proved indisputably. Its questionability becomes most striking if we think of certain specific instances. Even the most sensitive dentist cannot feel the piercing pains which his patient at times has to suffer under his treatment. He can ascertain them only indirectly, on the basis of the moans or squirming of the patient. Or, to speak of a more pleasant situation, such as for instance a banquet, however clearly one may sense the pleasure of one's neighbor over the taste of his favorite wine, it is something quite different from tasting it on one's own tongue. What *you* feel, think, want, only *you* can know as first-hand information. Other people can conclude it only indirectly, from your words, conduct, actions and mannerisms. When such physical manifestations are entirely absent, they have no basis whatever to enable them to know your momentary mental state.

This contrast between first-hand, or direct, and second-hand, or indirect, experience is a fundamental one. Since our primary aim is to gain direct, first-hand experience, we shall now discuss the interrelation of our mental and physical states.

First of all, we find that we may speak of conscious states only. To be sure, many processes, perhaps even the most decisive ones, must be taking place in the subconscious mind. But these are beyond the reach of scientific analysis. For there exists no science of the unconscious, or subconscious, mind. It would be a contradiction in terms, a self-contradiction. One does not know that which is subconscious. Therefore, all problems concerning the subconscious are phantom problems.

Let us therefore take a simple conscious process involving body and mind. I prick my hand with a needle, and feel a sensation of pain. The wound made by the pin is the physical element, the sensation of pain is the mental element of the process. The wound is seen, the pain is felt. Is there, then, an indisputable method of throwing light upon the interrelation of the two elements of this process? It is easy to realize that this is absolutely impossible. For there is nothing here upon which light is to be thrown. The visual perception of the wound and the feeling of the pain are elementary facts of experience, but they are as different in nature as knowledge and feeling. Therefore, the question as to their essential interrelation represents no meaningful problem—it is just a phantom problem.